

Document 26. Timing Drill Protocols

Paper 1 (CSQ) and Paper 2 (Essay) pacing protocols. Each paper is 2 hours 15 minutes (135 minutes). Use these protocols to ensure full coverage and built-in buffer time.

Section A. Paper 1 — CSQ Protocol (135 minutes for 2 CSQs)

Minutes 0–3. *Skim both CSQs.* Read the questions only. Note command words and topic.

Minutes 3–6. *Read extracts.* Annotate evidence likely to support each part.

Minutes 6–65. *CSQ 1* (max 60 minutes).

Minutes 65–125. *CSQ 2* (max 60 minutes).

Minutes 125–135. *Buffer / proofread.* Re-check any blank parts, sign your name on every booklet.

Within each CSQ (30 marks, ~60 minutes), allocate roughly 2 minutes per mark. For example: a 2–3–4–6–7–8 mark split yields 4–6–8–12–14–16 minutes.

Rule: when you exceed the time budget for a part by >10%, move on. Returns to incomplete parts are cheaper than over-investing in a 1-mark gain.

Section B. Paper 2 — Essay Protocol (135 minutes for 3 essays)

Minutes 0–5. *Choose 3 essays.* Read all 6 questions. Choose at least 1 micro and 1 macro. Avoid being lured by a topic you know but a command word that doesn't fit. **Critical:** verify you have answered the question, not the topic.

Minutes 5–45. *Essay 1* (~40 minutes including plan).

Minutes 45–85. *Essay 2* (~40 minutes).

Minutes 85–125. *Essay 3* (~40 minutes).

Minutes 125–135. *Buffer / proofread.*

Section C. Within an Essay (25 marks, ~40 minutes)

Minutes 0–3. *Plan.* Write the thesis sentence; list 3–4 body points with diagrams; write the evaluation stance.

Minutes 3–6. *Introduction.* Define terms, state thesis, signpost structure (1 paragraph).

Minutes 6–18. *Body part (a) [10 marks].* Two paragraphs, each with a diagram if applicable. 3–4 body sentences per paragraph.

Minutes 18–35. *Body part (b) [15 marks].* Two-sided treatment. Three to four substantive paragraphs.

Minutes 35–38. *Evaluation paragraph.* C-E-F test. Take a stance.

Minutes 38–40. *Conclusion.* Restate stance; synthesise; one forward-looking sentence.

Section D. Diagnostic Protocols

What to do if you are running over time on a question:

1. Skip evaluation and use the remaining 90 seconds to write a one-sentence evaluation stance.

2. Skip the conclusion if there is no time; an open-ended discussion is penalised less than a missing answer.
3. Move to the next question. Do not chase marks below the time-cost.

What to do if you finish a CSQ part with 5+ minutes spare:

1. Add a second evaluation point.
2. Strengthen the data reference (quote specific numbers from the extract).
3. Improve the diagram with welfare-area shading.

Section E. Pre-Exam Routine (last 24 hours)

1. Sleep 8 hours.
2. Eat a light breakfast 1 hour before the paper.
3. Review only your one-page cheat sheets (this suite's Tier 2). Do not learn new material.
4. Pack identity card, calculator (silent), 2 pens, ruler, pencil, eraser.
5. Arrive at venue 30 minutes early.